

Chapter 15

The Early Renaissance in Fifteenth-Century Italy

Learning Objectives

1. Define the characteristics of Italian Renaissance style.
2. Summarize the intellectual and social factors that inform Renaissance art.
3. Discuss the spread of artistic ideas into and out of Florence.
4. Describe the settings for which works of art were made in the Italian Renaissance.
5. Recognize the most important artists and patrons of the fifteenth century.



Paolo Uccello NICCOLÒ DA TOLENTINO LEADING THE CHARGE
Detail from *The Battle of San Romano* (FIG. 20-24), 1438–1440.

Tempera on wood panel. National Gallery, London. © 2016. Copyright The National Gallery, London/Scala, Florence.

Humanism and the Italian Renaissance

(1 of 2)

- Cities grew in wealth as people migrated from the countryside, and commerce became increasingly vital.
- Italian humanists looked back to art and determined that achievements of the Classical world were followed by a perceived decline.
 - They sought to revive physical and literary records of the ancient world.

Humanism and the Italian Renaissance

(2 of 2)

- Artists turned to antiquity for inspiration and emulated what they saw in ancient Roman sculpture and architecture.
- Italian painters and sculptors increasingly rendered the illusion of physical reality in a more analytical way than that of northerners.

The Early Renaissance in Florence

- The fifteenth century witnessed the rise of the Medici family, who made their money through banking.
- The competitive atmosphere fostered both mercantile and artistic success.
- Florence was considered a republic.
 - Artists could look to the Church, state (government and guilds), and individuals for patronage.

The Competition Reliefs (1 of 2)

- Florence Cathedral sponsored a competition for the artist of the bronze doors and chose the scene of Abraham's sacrifice of Isaac.
- Surviving panels belong to assumed finalists Lorenzo Ghiberti and Brunelleschi.

The Competition Reliefs (2 of 2)

- Brunelleschi's composition is rugged, explosive, and intense.
- Ghiberti's version is graceful with controlled poses and harmonious pairing of son and father.
 - His work proved to be lighter and less expensive when he was declared winner.
- Brunelleschi withdrew his entry.



Filippo Brunelleschi SACRIFICE OF ISAAC
1401–1402. Bronze with gilding, 21 × 17-1/2" (53 × 44 cm) inside molding.
Museo Nazionale del Bargello, Florence. © Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence



Lorenzo Ghiberti SACRIFICE OF ISAAC
1401–1402. Bronze with gilding, 21 × 17-1/2" (53 × 44 cm) inside molding.
Museo Nazionale del Bargello, Florence. © Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.

Filippo Brunelleschi, Architect (1 of 6)

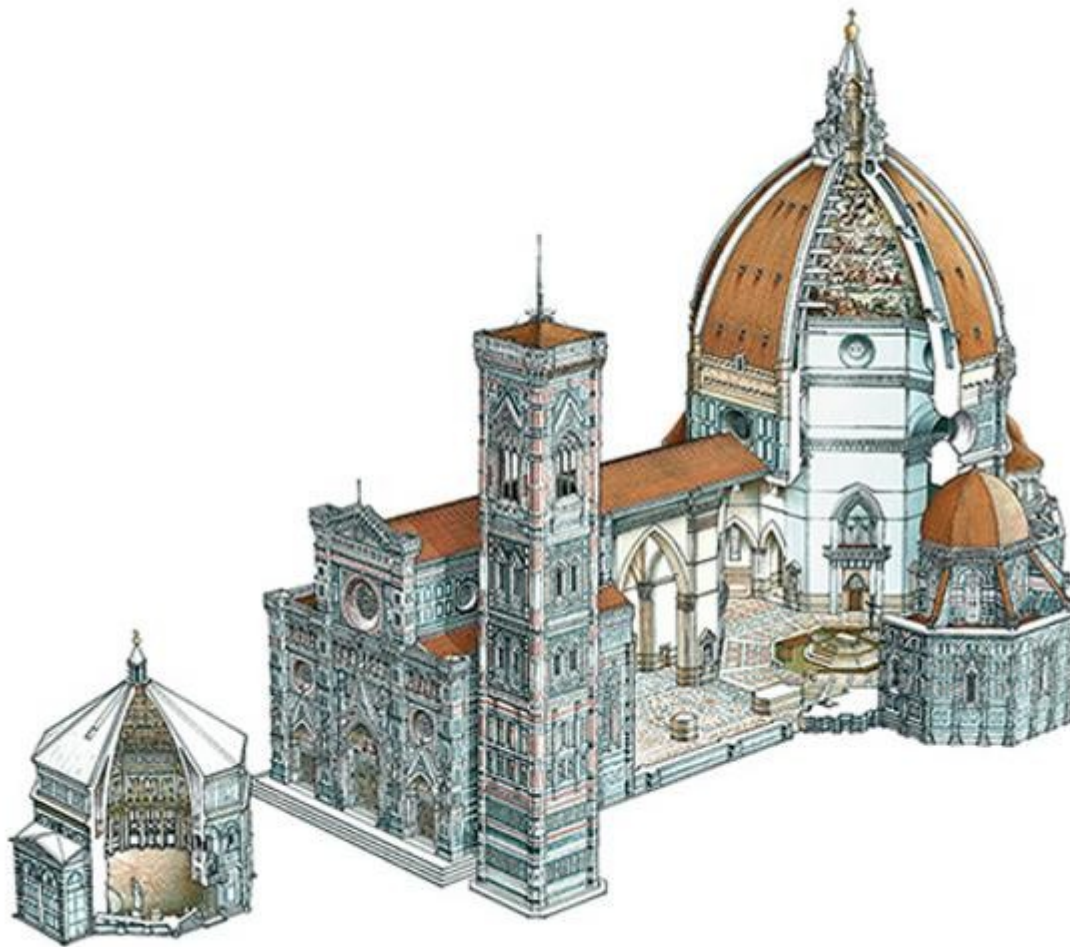
- The defining civic project in Florence was the cathedral.
 - Construction began in the late thirteenth century, but architects did not yet have technology to complete the designed dome.
- Brunelleschi was a principal pioneer of Florentine architecture.

Filippo Brunelleschi, Architect (2 of 6)

- Florence Cathedral
 - The *Dome* of Florence Cathedral was a feat of engineering, with an octagonal outer shell and lower inner shell.
 - Each portion reinforced the next one as it was built layer by layer with no external support.



Filippo Brunelleschi DOME OF FLORENCE CATHEDRAL (SANTA MARIA DEL FIORE)
1420–1436; lantern completed 1471.
© Javier Martin/123RF.



SCHEMATIC DRAWING OF FLORENCE CATHEDRAL

The separate, central-plan building in front of the façade is the baptistery. Adjacent to the façade is a tall tower designed by Giotto in 1334.

© Dorling Kindersley.

Filippo Brunelleschi, Architect (3 of 6)

- The Foundling Hospital
 - The Ospedale degli Innocenti was unprecedented in scale and design.
 - Brunelleschi paid homage to traditional forms and introduced features key to the Italian Renaissance style.
 - A later addition in 1487 included spandrels with terra-cotta medallions.



Filippo Brunelleschi OSPEDALE DEGLI INNOCENTI (FOUNDLING HOSPITAL), FLORENCE
Designed 1419; begun under Brunelleschi's direct supervision 1421–1427; construction continued into the 1440s.
Deposit Photos/Glow Images.



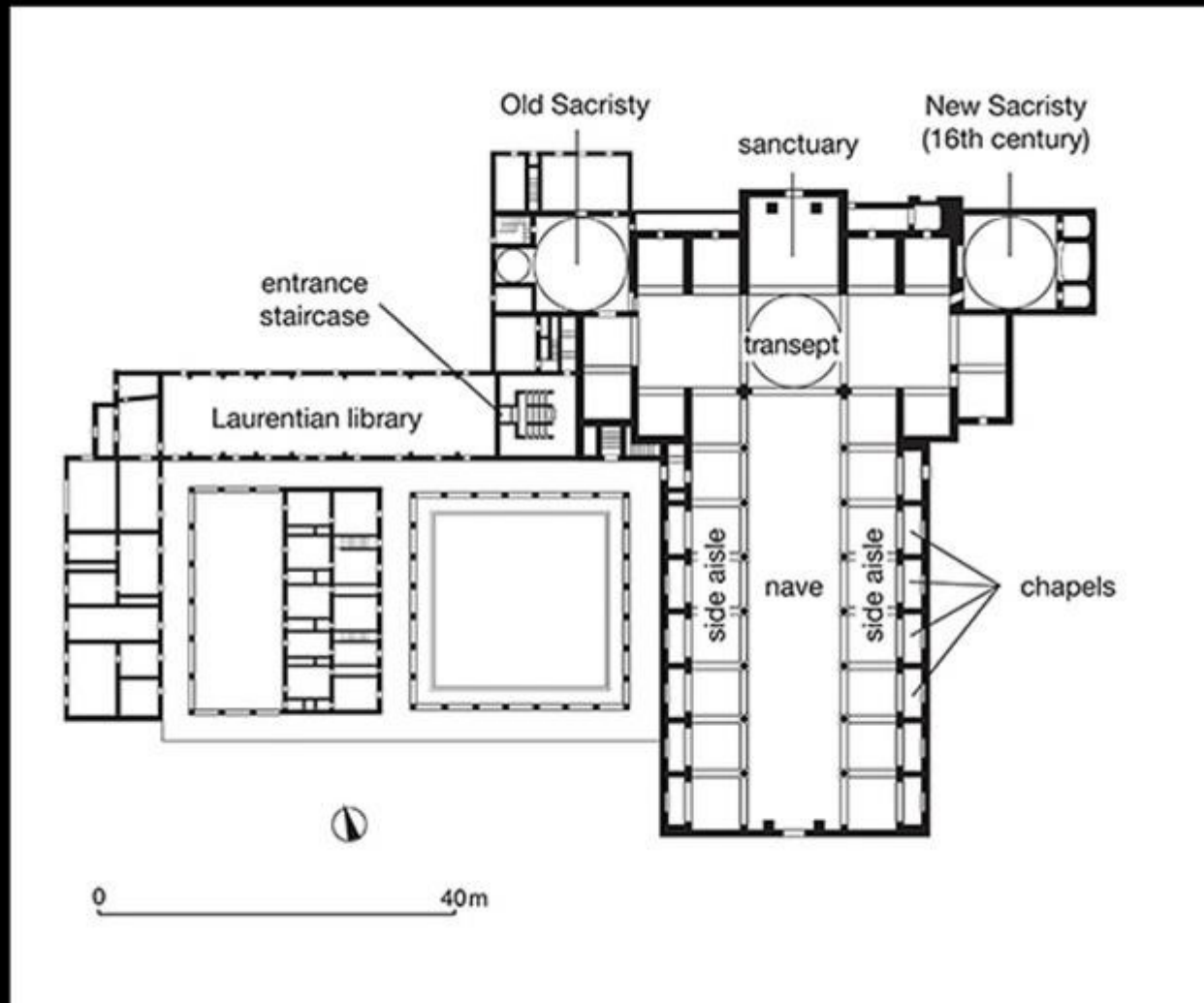
Andrea della Robbia INFANT IN SWADDLING CLOTHES (ONE OF THE HOLY INNOCENTS MASSACRED BY HEROD)
Ospedale degli Innocenti (Foundling Hospital), Florence. 1487.
Glazed terra cotta.
pio3/Fotolia.

Filippo Brunelleschi, Architect (4 of 6)

- San Lorenzo
 - Brunelleschi also reconstructed the Church of San Lorenzo.
 - Clear, rational interior spaces are in harmony with one another.
 - The austere Roman-style basilica with a long nave has arches that spring from an impost block.



Filippo Brunelleschi (continued by Michelozzo di Bartolomeo) INTERIOR OF CHURCH OF SAN LORENZO,
FLORENCE
c. 1421–1428; nave (designed 1434?) 1442–1470.
© Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.



Filippo Brunelleschi (continued by Michelozzo di Bartolomeo) PLAN OF CHURCH OF
 SAN LORENZO, FLORENCE
 c. 1421–1428; nave (designed 1434?) 1442–1470.

Filippo Brunelleschi, Architect (5 of 6)

- The Medici Palace
 - Brunelleschi had a role in the *Palazzo* Medici-Riccardi, although it was said that his model was rejected as too grand.
 - It is attributed to Michelozzo di Bartolomeo.
 - **Rusticated** stone blocks set the lower story apart from the upper levels.



Attributed to Michelozzo di Bartolomeo FAÇADE, PALAZZO MEDICI-RICCARDI, FLORENCE
Begun 1446 (the view shown here includes a two-bay extension constructed during the 18th
century). © Achim Bednorz, Cologne.

Filippo Brunelleschi, Architect (6 of 6)

- The Medici Palace
 - Inside the *Palazzo*, the Medici palace courtyard is square, with rooms arranged symmetrically.
 - The frieze is decorated with swags in **sgraffito**, which is produced by scratching through a layer of dark plaster or glaze.



COURTYARD WITH SGRAFFITO DECORATION, PALAZZO MEDICI-RICCARDI,
FLORENCE
Begun 1446.

Sculpture (1 of 6)

- Until 1428, Florence's independence were challenged by the anti-republican powers, the duchy of Milan and the kingdom of Naples.
- Florentines turned to commissions that expressed self-esteem and their city's magnificence.

Sculpture (2 of 6)

- Orsanmichele
 - A loggia that served as a grain market was erected with sculpted images of patron saints.
 - Nanni di Banco produced *The Four Crowned Martyrs* with reference to Roman sculpture.
 - The saints convey a new spatial relationship to the building and the viewer.



EXTERIOR VIEW OF ORSANMICHELE SHOWING SCULPTURE IN NICHES
Florence. Begun 1337.
© Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.



Nanni di Banco THE FOUR CROWNED MARTYRS
c. 1409–1417. Marble, height of figures 6' (1.83 m). Photographed *in situ* before removal of the figures to the Museo di
Orsanmichele, Florence.
© Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.

Sculpture (3 of 6)

- Orsanmichele
 - Donatello received three commissions for the niches at Orsanmichele.
 - As originally conceived *St. George* would have been a standing advertisement for the guild of armorers and swordmakers.
 - The figure of St. George stands in contrapposto with a complex expression on his determined face.



Donatello ST. GEORGE

Formerly in Orsanmichele, Florence. 1417–1420. Marble, height 6'5" (1.95 m).
Museo Nazionale del Bargello, Florence. © Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.

Sculpture (4 of 6)

- Donatello
 - Donatello made the statue of *David* to draw on the Classical tradition of heroic nudity.
 - It is unknown when this statue was made, but it was first recorded in 1469.
 - Some historians cite the angular pose as an attempt to heighten the character's heroism, while others see overt homoeroticism.



Donatello DAVID
c. 1446–1460(?). Bronze, height 5'2-1/4" (1.58 m).
Museo Nazionale del Bargello, Florence. © Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.

Sculpture (5 of 6)

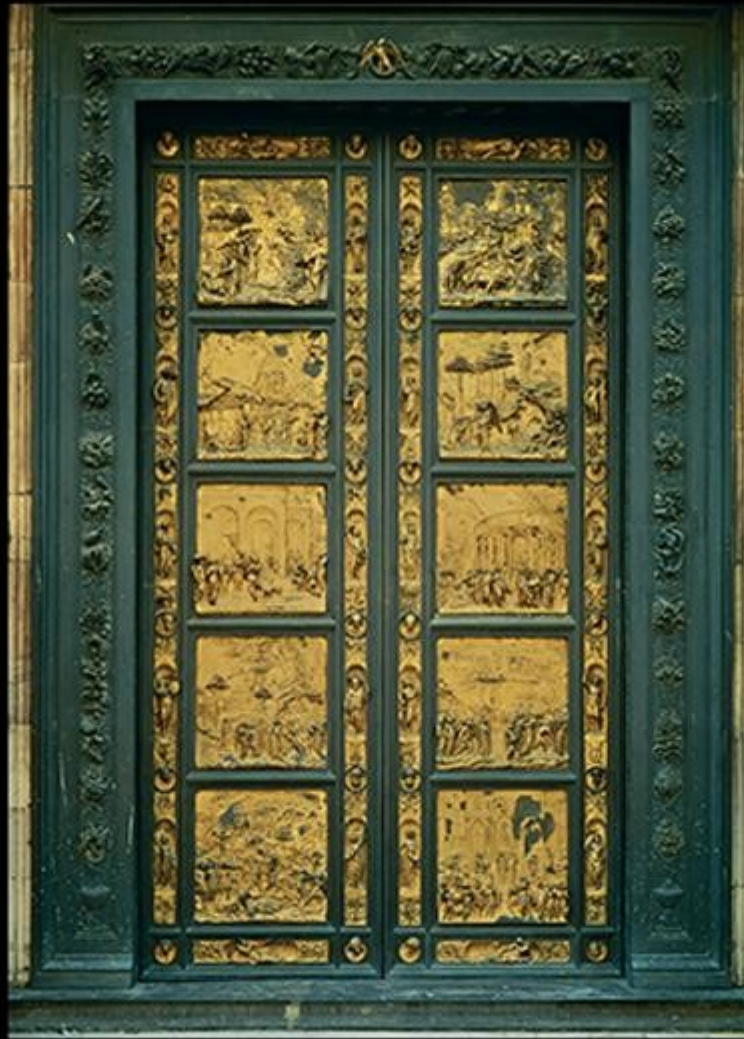
- Donatello
 - Called to Padua, Donatello created an equestrian statue of *Erasmus da Narni* nicknamed *Gattamelata*.
 - It was the first life-size bronze equestrian statue since antiquity.



Donatello EQUESTRIAN STATUE OF ERASMO DA NARNI (GATTAMELATA)
Piazza del Santo, Padua. 1443–1453.
Bronze, height approx. 12'2" (3.71 m).
© akg-images/Cameraphoto

Sculpture (6 of 6)

- Ghiberti's Gates of Paradise
 - Rival to Brunelleschi, Lorenzo Ghiberti labored on the bronze doors for Florence's baptistery, which were installed in 1452.
 - The story of Jacob and Esau demonstrates his attention to one-point perspective.
 - The vanishing point is under the loggia.



Lorenzo Ghiberti "GATES OF PARADISE" (EAST BAPTISTERY DOORS)
Formerly on the Baptistery of San Giovanni, Florence. 1425–1452.
Gilt bronze, height 15' (4.57 m).
Museo dell'Opera del Duomo, Florence. © 2016 Photo Scala, Florence.



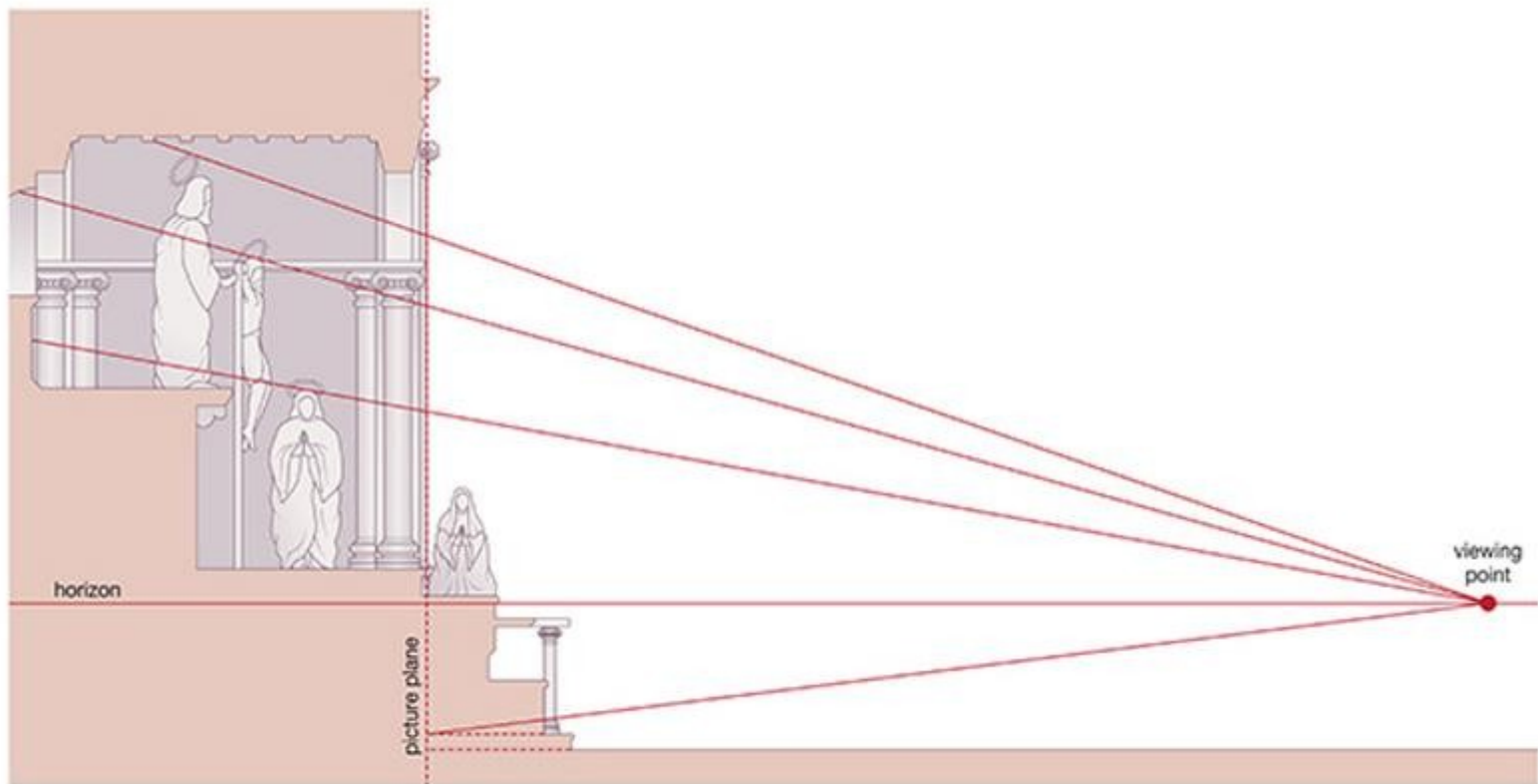
Lorenzo Ghiberti JACOB AND ESAU, PANEL OF THE "GATES OF PARADISE"
(EAST BAPTISTERY DOORS)
Formerly on the Baptistery of San Giovanni, Florence. c. 1435.
Gilded bronze, 31-1/4" (79 cm) square.
Museo dell'Opera del Duomo, Florence. © Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.

Masaccio (1 of 2)

- After a tradition of fresco painting, artists began to turn to oil paints.
- Masaccio (1401–1428) painted the *Trinity* fresco to give the illusion that a stone funerary monument and altar receded into a deep **aedicula** niche.
- The figures progress into space.
- A skeleton evokes mortality in viewers.



Masaccio TRINITY WITH THE VIRGIN, ST. JOHN THE EVANGELIST, AND DONORS
Church of Santa Maria Novella, Florence. c. 1425–1427/1428.
Fresco, 21' × 10'5" (6.4 × 3.2 m). © Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.



SECTION DIAGRAM OF THE ILLUSIONISTIC SPATIAL WORLD PORTRAYED IN
MASACCIO'S TRINITY

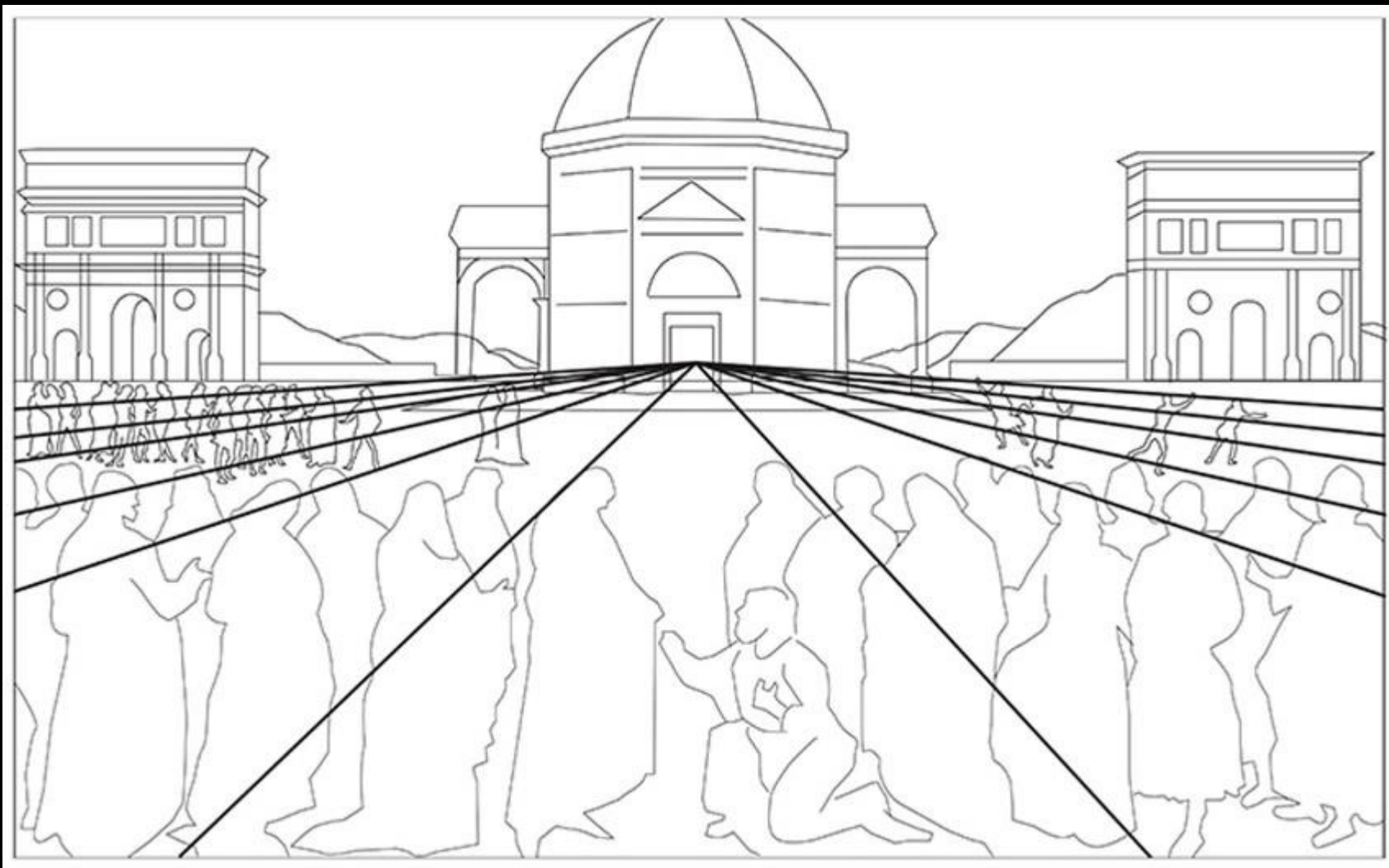
After Gene Brucker, *Florence: The Golden Age*, Berkeley, 1998.

Technique: Renaissance Perspective

- Linear perspective was a rational method used to make realistic architectural settings.
- Imaginary lines called orthogonals met at a single vanishing point on the horizon.
- Variations in color and clarity can also convey the feeling of distance in a painting.



Perugino CHRIST GIVING THE KEYS TO ST. PETER
Fresco on the right wall of the Sistine Chapel (see FIG. 20-41), Vatican, Rome. 1480–1482. 11'5-1/2" × 18'8-1/2" (3.48 × 5.70 m).



SCHEMATIC DRAWING SHOWING THE ORTHOGONALS AND VANISHING POINT OF
CHRIST GIVING THE KEYS TO ST. PETER
Canali Photobank, Milan, Italy

Masaccio (2 of 2)

- The Brancacci Chapel
 - *The Expulsion of Adam and Eve from Paradise* focuses on the mass of flesh of the figures' bodies and the psychological impact of shame.
 - *The Tribute Money* marks early use of linear and atmospheric perspective.
 - Foreground figures have bold highlights and long shadows on the ground.



Masaccio THE EXPULSION OF ADAM AND EVE FROM PARADISE
Brancacci Chapel, church of Santa Maria del Carmine, Florence. c. 1427.
Fresco, 7' x 2'11" (214 x 90 cm).
© Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.



Masaccio THE TRIBUTE MONEY
Brancacci Chapel, church of Santa Maria del Carmine, Florence. c. 1427.
Fresco, 8'1" × 19'7" (2.46 × 6 m).
© Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.

Painting in Florence After Masaccio

(1 of 4)

- Fra Angelico
 - The pious Fra Angelico worked in Florence as early as 1417.
 - His *Annunciation* uses linear perspective to extend the corridor of the monastery where it was painted into an imagined portico and garden.
 - Slender, graceful figures render the scene with contemporary details.



Fra Angelico ANNUNCIATION
North dormitory corridor, monastery of San Marco, Florence. c. 1438–1445.
Fresco, 7'1" × 10'6" (2.2 × 3.2 m).
© Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.

Painting in Florence After Masaccio

(2 of 4)

- Uccello
 - Paolo Uccello emerged as an eccentric painter specializing in the study of linear perspective.
 - An example is seen in *The Battle of San Romano*.



Paolo Uccello THE BATTLE OF SAN ROMANO

1438–1440. Tempera on wood panel, approx. 6' × 10'6" (1.82 × 3.2 m).

National Gallery, London. © 2016. Copyright The National Gallery, London/Scala, Florence

Painting in Florence After Masaccio

(3 of 4)

- Castagno
 - Andrea del Castagno is best known for *The Last Supper*, a fresco showing Jesus and his followers at a humble-looking house.
 - Judas takes a traditional position on the viewer's side of the table.



Andrea del Castagno THE LAST SUPPER
Refectory, convent of Sant'Apollonia, Florence. 1447.
Fresco, width approx. 16 × 32' (4.6 × 9.8 m).
© Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.

Painting in Florence After Masaccio

(4 of 4)

- Fra Filippo Lippi
 - *Portrait of a Woman and Man* is an early work by Lippi.
 - Emphasis is squarely on the woman, spotlighted in the foreground.
 - There is no sense of engagement with the viewer and little sense of likeness of the figures to their sitters.
 - It is a puzzle to art historians as to what this painting symbolizes.



Fra Filippo Lippi PORTRAIT OF A WOMAN AND MAN (ANGIOLA DI BERNARDO SAPITI AND LORENZO DI RANIERI SCOLARI?)
c. 1435–1445. Tempera on wood panel, 25-1/4" × 16-1/2" (64.1 × 41.9 cm). Metropolitan Museum of Art, New York. © 2016. Image copyright The Metropolitan Museum of Art/Art Resource/Scala, Florence.

Florentine Art in the Second Half of the Fifteenth Century

- Sculptors in Florence continued to explore Classical themes.

Verrocchio

- Trained as a goldsmith, Verrocchio was best known for works in paint and bronze.
- *David* seems to have been conceived in response to Donatello's sculpture.



Andrea del Verrocchio DAVID
Commissioned by Lorenzo de' Medici for the Medici Palace. c. 1470–1475.
Bronze with gilded details, height 49-5/8" (1.26 m).
Museo Nazionale del Bargello, Florence. © Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence

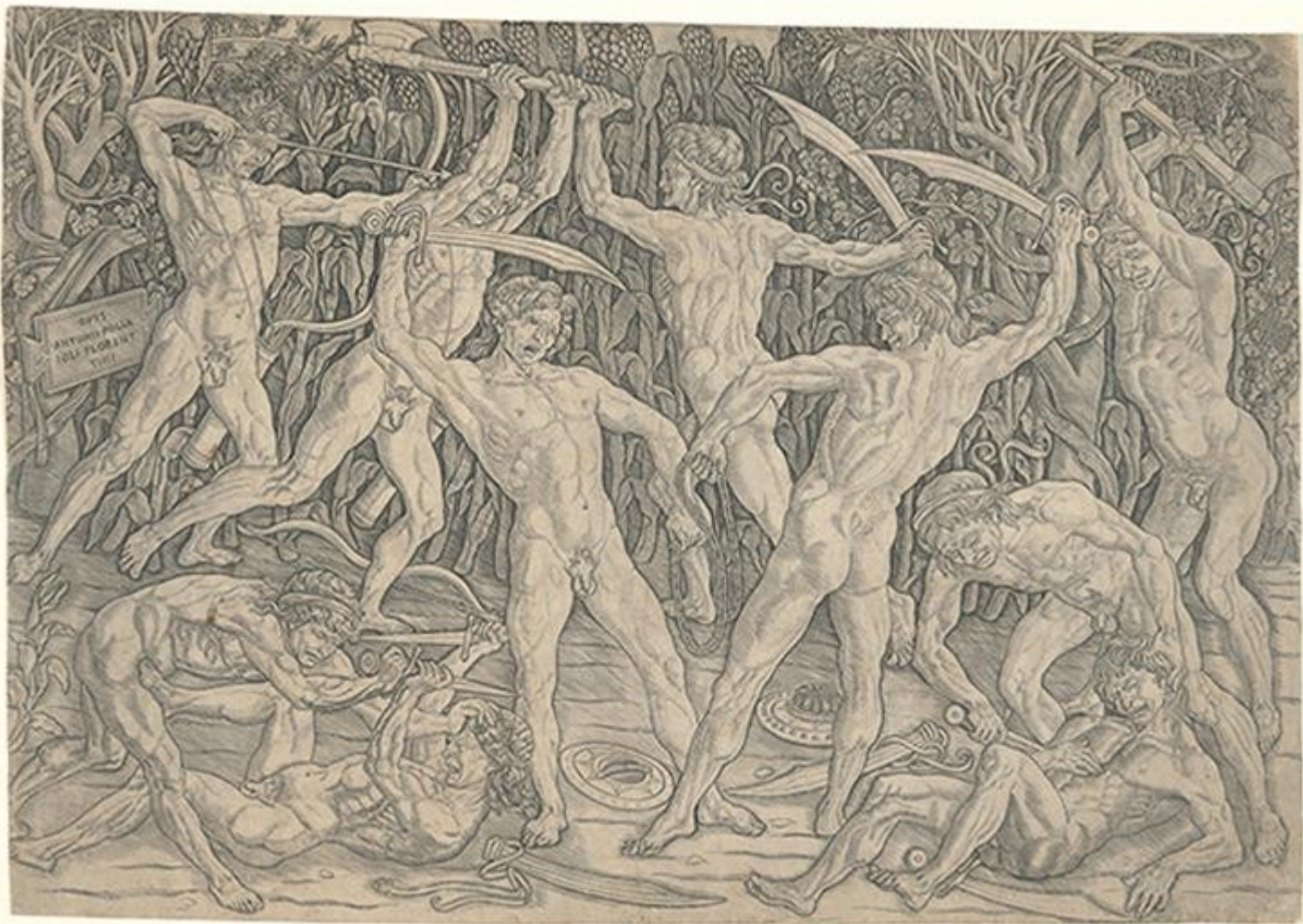
Pollaiuolo

- *Hercules and Antaeus* is a sculpted study of complex, interlocking figures and can be appreciated best from every angle.
- The engraved *Battle of the Nudes* reflects both the study of Classical sculpture and anatomical research.



Antonio del Pollaiuolo HERCULES AND ANTAEUS
c. 1475. Bronze, height with base 18" (45.7 cm).

Museo Nazionale del Bargello, Florence. © 2016. Photo Scala, Florence - courtesy of the Ministero Beni e Att. Culturali.



Antonio del Pollaiuolo THE BATTLE OF THE NUDES
c. 1490. Engraving, 15-3/4" x 22-13/16" (40 x 58 cm).

Yale University Art Gallery, New Haven, Connecticut. Maitland F. Griggs, B.A. 1896, Fund (1951.9.18). Image courtesy
Yale University Art Gallery.

The Morelli-Nerli Wedding Chests

- **Cassoni** were chests used to store clothing and other objects in a couple's bedroom, associated with wedding gifts.
- Marriages in Florence were political alliances rather than based in romance.
- This example shows paintings with subjects drawn from stories extolling moral virtues.



Jacopo del Sellaio, Biagio d'Antonio (painters), and Zanobi di Domenico (woodworker) CASSONE MADE FOR THE MARRIAGE OF LORENZO DI MATTEO MORELLI AND VAGGIA DI TANAI NERLI (ONE OF A SET OF TWO)
1472. Tempera and gold on wood, chest 83-1/2" x 75" x 30" (212 x 193 x 76.2 cm).
The Samuel Courtauld Trust, The Courtauld Gallery, London. (F.1947.LF.4) © Samuel Courtauld Trust, The Courtauld Gallery, London, UK/Bridgeman Images

Ghirlandaio (1 of 2)

- *The Life of St. Francis* was commissioned for the walls of the Sassetti burial chapel.
 - Foreground figures are portraits of well-known Florentines.
 - The scene takes place in the actual piazza outside the church of Santa Trinità.



Domenico Ghirlandaio SCENES FROM THE LIFE OF ST. FRANCIS; ALTARPIECE WITH NATIVITY AND ADORATION OF THE SHEPHERDS
 Sassetti Chapel, church of Santa Trinità, Florence. 1483–1486.
 Fresco, chapel 12'2" deep × 17'2" wide (3.7 × 5.25 m).
 © Archivi Alinari, Firenze.



Domenico Ghirlandaio CONFIRMATION OF THE FRANCISCAN RULE BY
POPE HONORIUS III
Sasseti Chapel, church of Santa Trinità, Florence. 1483–1486.
Fresco, width at base 17'2" (5.25 m).
© Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.

Ghirlandaio (2 of 2)

- *Nativity and Adoration of the Shepherds* was the altarpiece of the chapel, still in its original frame.
 - It was heavily influenced by the Portinari Altarpiece, but also draws upon Classical references to Rome.
 - **Aerial perspective** creates a seamless transition of color.



Domenico Ghirlandaio NATIVITY AND ADORATION OF THE SHEPHERDS
Altarpiece in the Sassetti Chapel, church of Santa Trinità, Florence. 1485.
Panel, 65-3/4" square (1.67 m square).
© Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence

Botticelli (1 of 2)

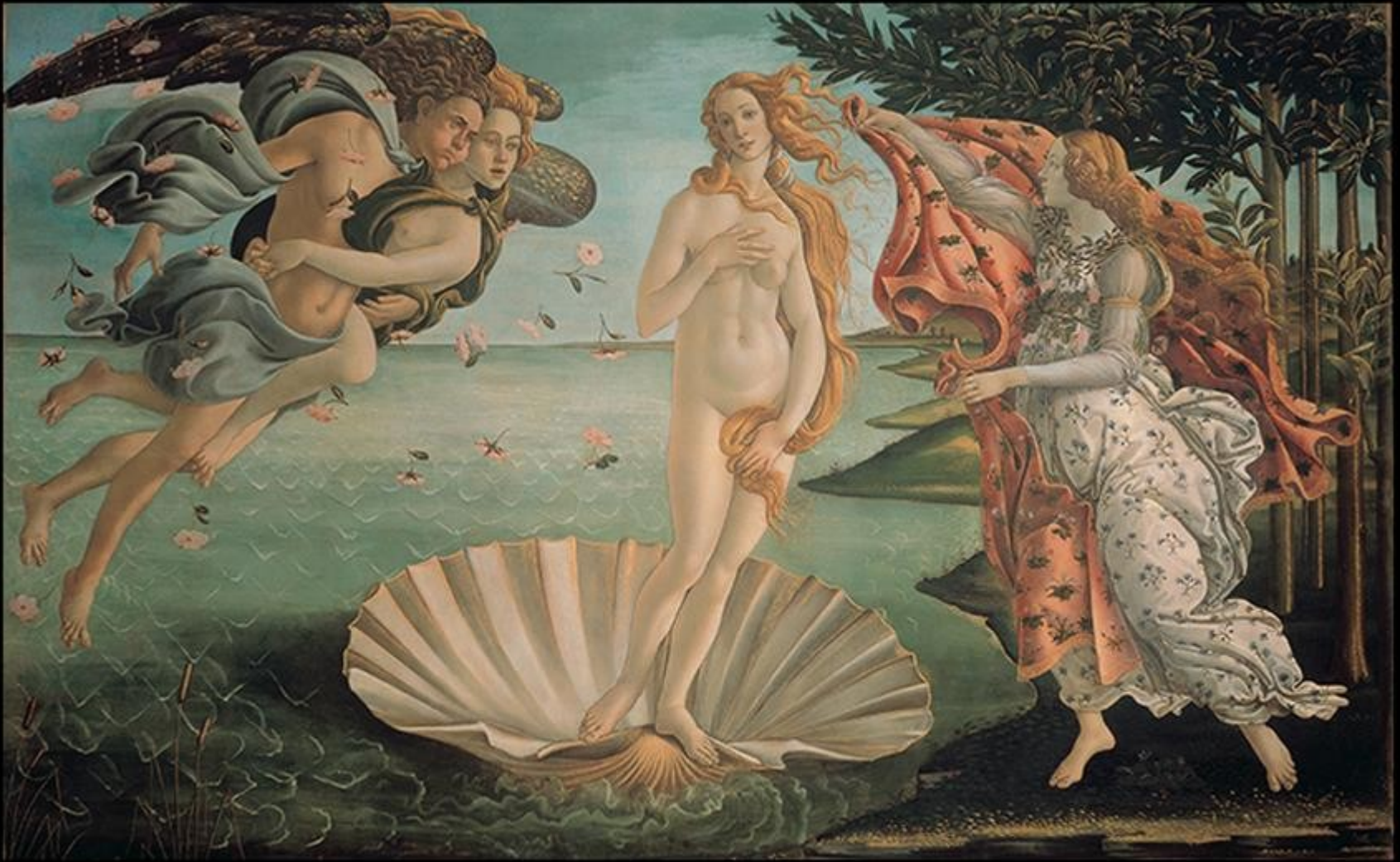
- The overall appearance of *Primavera* recalls Flemish tapestries.
 - It is a complex **allegory** of Neoplatonic philosophers' conceptions of Venus as having two natures.
 - It was painted at the time of the wedding of Lorenzo de' Medici and Semiramide d'Appiano in 1482.



A CLOSER LOOK: Primavera by Sandro Botticelli
c. 1482. Tempera on wood panel.
6'8" × 10'4" (2.03 × 3.15 m).
Galleria degli Uffizi, Florence. © Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.

Botticelli (2 of 2)

- Sandro Botticelli's *Birth of Venus* depicted Classical figures with fluid grace.
- The "modest Venus" image derives from a Classical Greek statue often copied by the Romans.



Sandro Botticelli BIRTH OF VENUS
c. 1484–1486. Tempera and gold on canvas, 5'8-7/8" × 9'1-7/8" (1.8 × 2.8 m).
Galleria degli Uffizi, Florence. © Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.

Urbino, Mantua, Rome, and Venice

- The ideas of Brunelleschi, Donatello, Masaccio, and other contemporaries spread from Florence to the rest of Italy.

Urbino (1 of 4)

- The Palace at Urbino
 - Luciano Laurana's design of the courtyard avoided the awkwardness of two arches springing from a single column.
 - He used a variation of the composite capital on the ground level.



Luciano Laurana COURTYARD, DUCAL PALACE, URBINO
Courtyard c. 1467–1472; palace begun c. 1450.
© akg-images/De Agostini Picture Lib./L. Romano.

Urbino (2 of 4)

- The Palace at Urbino
 - The interior featured **trompe l'oeil** paintings, enhanced by linear perspective and foreshortening.
 - An example is the Studolio, or study, featuring the motif of a squirrel.



Giuliano da Maiano (?) STUDIOLLO OF FEDERICO DA MONTEFELTRO

Ducal palace, Urbino. 1476.

Intarsia, height 7'3" (2.21 m).

© 2016. Photo Scala, Florence – courtesy of the Ministero Beni e Att. Culturali.

Urbino (3 of 4)

- Piero della Francesca
 - Piero was one of few practicing artists who also wrote his own theory books.
 - *Baptism of Christ*, his signature work, shows a central Christ next to a tree trunk.
 - A radically foreshortened dove, John's baptismal dish, and clouds add stability above the vertical forms.



Piero della Francesca BAPTISM OF CHRIST
c. 1450. Tempera on wood panel, 66" × 45-3/4" (1.67 × 1.16 m).
National Gallery, London. © 2016. Copyright The National Gallery, London/Scala, Florence.

Urbino (4 of 4)

- Piero della Francesca
 - The portraits of Federico and Battista Sforza are in strict profile, disengaging them from the viewer but drawing attention away from Federico's scars.
 - The figures' meticulous clothes are silhouetted by atmospheric perspective.



Piero della Francesca BATTISTA SFORZA AND FEDERICO DA MONTEFELTRO
c. 1474. Oil on wood panel, each 18-1/2" x 13" (47 x 33 cm).
Galleria degli Uffizi, Florence. © Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence.

Mantua

- Andrea Mantenga (1431–1506) worked for the court of Ludovico Gonzaga.
- Mantenga
 - The Camera Picta of the ducal palace displays unprecedented perspective and foreshortening.
 - Figures are seen *di sotto in sù* (directly from below), beginning a tradition of illusionistic ceiling painting.



Andrea Mantegna TWO VIEWS OF THE CAMERA PICTA, DUCAL PALACE, MANTUA
1465–1474. Fresco, diameter of false oculus 8'9" (2.7 m);
room 26'6" square (8 m square).

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Andrea Mantegna TWO VIEWS OF THE CAMERA PICTA, DUCAL PALACE, MANTUA
1465–1474. Fresco, diameter of false oculus 8'9" (2.7 m);
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© 2016. Photo Scala, Florence - courtesy of the Ministero Beni e Att. Culturali; © Studio Fotografico Quattrone, Florence

Rome

- Botticelli and Ghirlandaio were some of the first famous artists summoned to paint the Sistine Chapel, but art historians believe Perugino supervised the project.
- Perugino
 - *Christ Giving the Keys to St. Peter* detailed figures with perfect scale, modeling, and perspective.



VIEW OF THE SISTINE CHAPEL SHOWING PAINTINGS COMMISSIONED FOR THE SIDE WALLS BY POPE SIXTUS IV
Vatican, Rome. At lower right, Perugino's *Christ Giving the Keys to St. Peter*,
c. 1480–1482. 11'5-1/2" × 18'8-1/2" (3.48 × 5.70 m).
Photo © Musei Vaticani/IKONA

Venice (1 of 5)

- Venice emerged as a center for the arts as well as a commercial seaport.
- The church of St. Mark was designed as a great Byzantine building, decorated with mosaics.
- Textiles, jewelry, gold, enamel, glass, fine printing, and bookbinding were other specialties of Venetians.

Venice (2 of 5)

- Venetian Palaces
 - The Ca d'Oro was home to nobleman Marino Contarini and features asymmetrical elevation and a Byzantine plan.
 - The façade was painted with white enamel and ultramarine blue.



CA D'ORO (CONTARINI PALACE), VENICE
1421–1437.
© Cameraphoto Arte, Venice.

Venice (3 of 5)

- The Bellini Brothers
 - Gentile Bellini created large, lively narratives such as the *Procession of the Relic of the True Cross before the Church of St. Mark*.
 - It serves as a reminder that fifteenth-century piazzas and buildings were sites of ritual ceremony.



Gentile Bellini PROCESSION OF THE RELIC OF THE TRUE CROSS BEFORE
THE CHURCH OF ST. MARK
1496. Oil on canvas, 12' x 24'5" (3.67 x 7.45 m).
Galleria dell'Accademia, Venice. © Cameraphoto Arte, Venice.

Venice (4 of 5)

- The Bellini Brothers
 - Giovanni Bellini's artistic virtuosity is seen in the *Virgin and Child Enthroned with SS. Francis, John the Baptist, Job, Dominic, Sebastian, and Louis of Toulouse*.
 - It exhibits radical foreshortening and a low vanishing point.



Giovanni Bellini VIRGIN AND CHILD ENTHRONED WITH SS. FRANCIS, JOHN THE BAPTIST, JOB, DOMINIC, SEBASTIAN, AND LOUIS OF
TOULOUSE
Originally commissioned for the chapel of the Hospital of San Giobbe, Venice. c. 1478. Oil on wood panel, 15'4" × 8'4" (4.67 × 2.54 m). Galleria
dell'Accademia, Venice.
© Cameraphoto Arte, Venice.

Venice (5 of 5)

- The Bellini Brothers
 - Giovanni's *St. Francis in Ecstasy* recalls Flemish art due to its fine detail.
 - The natural world depicted is saturated with religious symbolism.



Giovanni Bellini ST. FRANCIS IN ECSTASY
c. 1470s. Oil and tempera on wood panel, 49-1/16 × 55-7/8" (124.6 × 142 cm).
The Frick Collection, New York.